

LOW CODE

EXPERIMENT- 2

Setting Up a Zoho Creator Account and Exploring the Platform

Architecture and Interface

AIM

To create a Zoho Creator account, develop and examine a sample application using forms, reports, and dashboards, while gaining an understanding of the platform structure and the Develop, Deploy, and Manage sections of the Zoho Creator interface.

SETTING UP ZOHO CREATOR

Zoho Creator is a cloud-based low-code application development platform. Applications can be created through a browser using visual development tools, without requiring large amounts of manual programming.

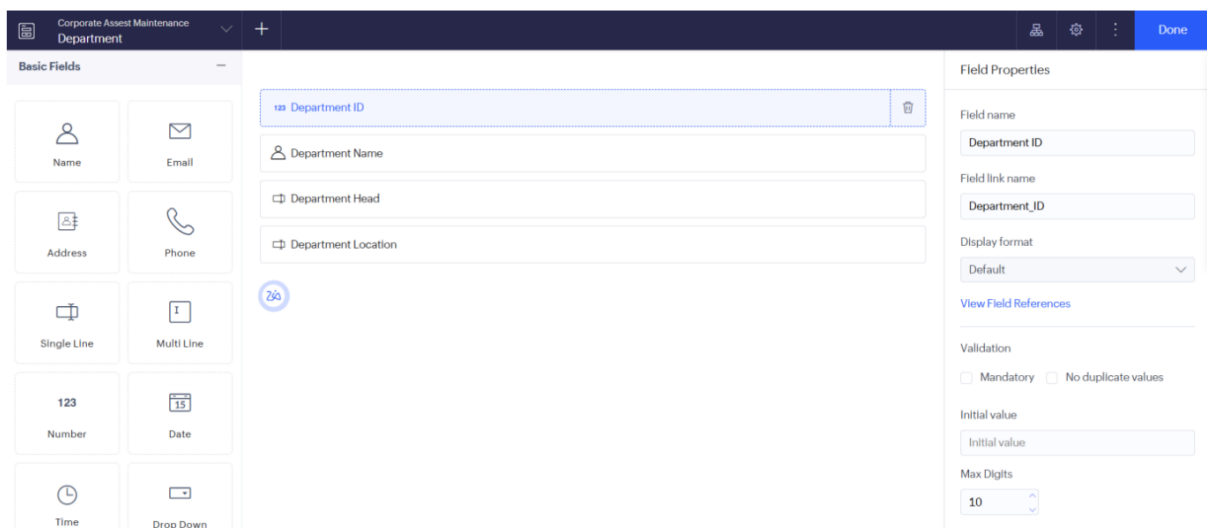
I) Create the Sample Application

1. Open the Zoho Creator website and sign in using a Zoho account. If you do not have an account, create a Zoho account and then open Zoho Creator.
2. From the Creator home page, select the option to create a new solution/application.
3. Choose Applications and select Create from Scratch.
4. Enter a suitable application name, such as "CORPORATE ASSET MAINTENANCE", and create the application.
5. The application design window opens. From here, components such as Forms, Reports, Pages and Workflows can be added and configured.
6. For this experiment, create a simple Student Management System containing a Student Details form, a Student Report and a Student Dashboard.

Creating a Form

A form is used to collect and store data from users. In Zoho Creator, forms are one of the main components of an application. Create the Student Details form and add fields such as Student Name, Register Number, Department, Email and Phone Number.

7. Open the application in edit/design mode.
8. Click the + (Add) option and select Form.
9. Choose From Scratch and enter the form name as “Student Details”.
10. Drag and drop the required fields into the form builder.
11. Configure the field properties and save the form.
12. Open the form in live mode and enter a few sample student records.



Creating a Report

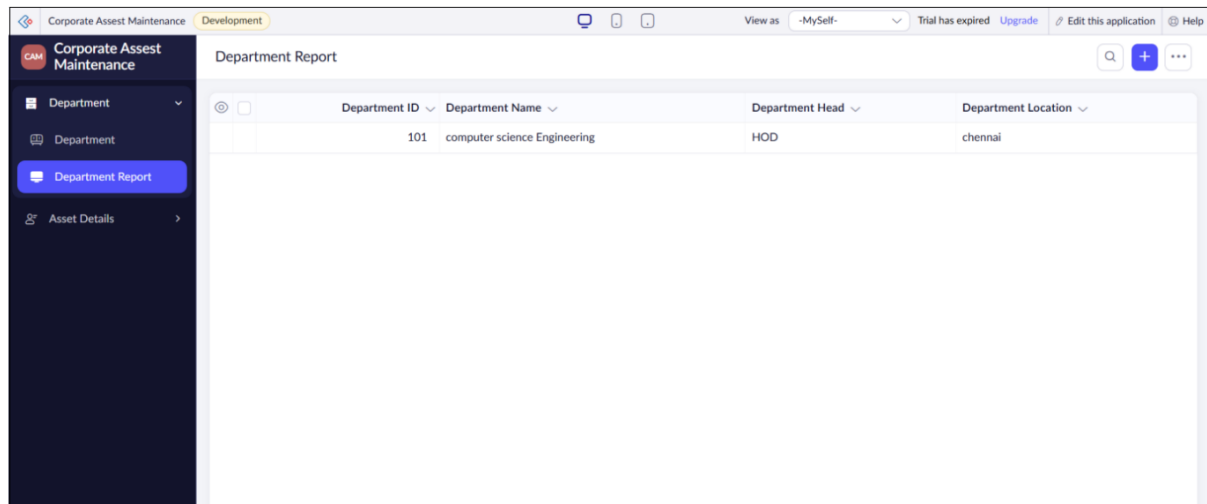
A report displays the data collected through a form in a meaningful format. A list report is normally created automatically when a form is created, and additional reports can be customized according to the application's requirements.

13. Open the application design page.
14. Select the option to add a new Report, if a separate report is required.
15. Choose the Student Details form as the data source.

16. Select a suitable report type, such as List.

17. Name the report "Student Report".

18. Configure sorting, filtering or grouping if required and save the report.



Creating a Dashboard

A dashboard provides a visual summary of application information. It can be used to display important metrics and visual components in one place. For this experiment, create a Student Dashboard and add suitable reports or visual components.

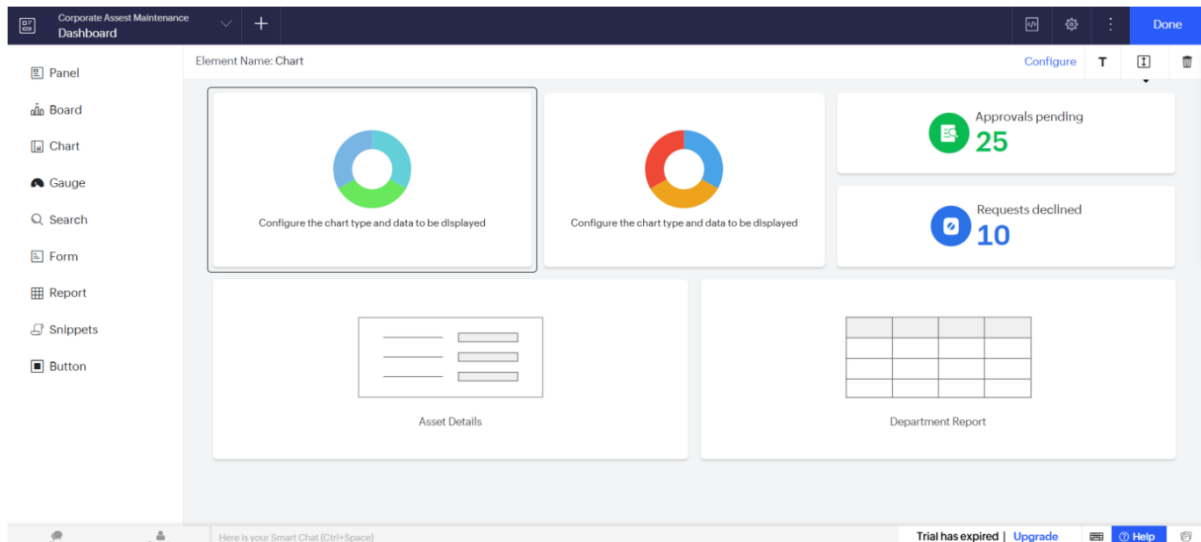
19. Open the application/page builder and create or open the required dashboard/page area.

20. Name the dashboard "Student Dashboard".

21. Add suitable report or visual components based on the Student Details data.

22. Arrange the components using the visual/drag-and-drop interface.

23. Save and preview the dashboard to verify that the information is displayed correctly.



Exploring the Platform Architecture and Interface

Zoho Creator is a web-based low-code environment that enables users to build applications through visual tools and components. It supports the creation, testing, and deployment of applications, while also providing options to manage users, settings, environments, and other configurations.

Develop

- The **Develop** section is mainly used to build and edit applications and their components.
- It allows users to create **forms, reports, pages, workflows**, and other application elements.
- This section provides the primary workspace for designing and customizing application features.

Deploy

- The **Deploy** section helps publish applications and make them accessible to intended users.
- It supports organized development, testing, and production processes when multiple environments are configured.
- Deployment features may include publishing applications and setting up access through portals or other available options.

Manage

- The **Manage** section handles application settings, user accounts, permissions, and administrative options.
- Administrators can control application information, user access, permissions, and environment settings based on their roles.
- It helps monitor and maintain the application after development and deployment are completed.

RESULT

The Zoho Creator account and sample **Student Management System** were successfully created and examined. A form was designed for entering student information, while a report was generated to organize and display the stored records. A dashboard was also developed to present the information visually. In addition, the **Develop, Deploy, and Manage** sections of the Zoho Creator platform were explored to understand their roles in application creation, deployment, and administration.